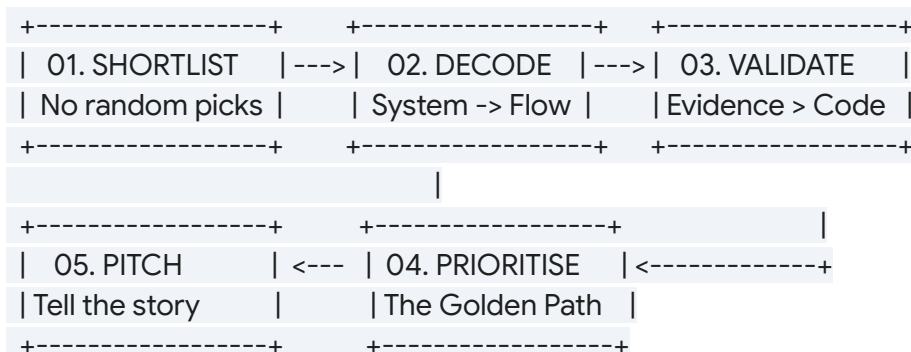


Product Playbook for SIH (Smart India Hackathon) Teams

Core Philosophy: *Cool tech + weak problem = expensive demo.* Hackathon success is not building 17 features; it is proving that the pain is real, the user is obvious, the tech is feasible, the MVP is focused, and the impact is measurable.

1. Overview: The 5-Stage Framework



2. Phase 1: Shortlist the Right Problem Statement

Avoid vs. Evaluate

- **Avoid ("Buzzword Energy"):**
 - "It has AI, so it must be good"
 - "Complex = impressive"
 - "We'll figure out users later"
 - "Dashboard bana denge" (Building random dashboards)
- **Evaluate (Real Value):**
 - Is the pain real and frequent?
 - Can we reach the user or a proxy user?
 - Can we validate quickly?
 - Can we build the core flow (the golden path)?
 - Can we show a clear before/after contrast?

Problem Shortlisting Scorecard

Score each problem statement from **1 to 5** across 8 parameters:

Metric	Evaluation Question
Pain Level	Is this annoying/costly enough to fix?
User Access	Can we reach real or proxy users?
Scope Clarity	Can we avoid boiling the ocean?
Buildability	Can we ship the golden path during the hackathon?
Data Reality	Do we have access to data or a clean proxy?
The Edge	What makes our approach actually better?
Demo Moment	Will the demo make sense quickly to judges?
Metric	Can we numerically prove the improvement?

PM Tip: Do not just chase the highest score. Debate the “why”—disagreements reveal hidden assumptions.

3. Phase 2: Decode Government Problem Statements

Government problem statements typically describe **system-level needs**. Product managers must turn them into **human-level workflows**.

+-----+	
	DECODING FRAMEWORK
	[ACTOR] ---> Who is the human in the flow?
	[ACTION] ---> What job are they trying to finish?
	[FRICTION] --> Where does the process get messy/delayed?
	[IMPACT] ---> Why should anyone care about solving this?
+-----+	

Case Study: Citizen Grievance Management

- | | | | | | | |
|---------------------|-------|------------------------------|-------|--------------------|-------|---------------------|
| [Citizen Complaint] | ----> | (District Grievance Officer) | ----> | [Classify & Route] | ----> | [Faster Resolution] |
| (Input) | | (User) | | (Core Job) | | (Outcome) |

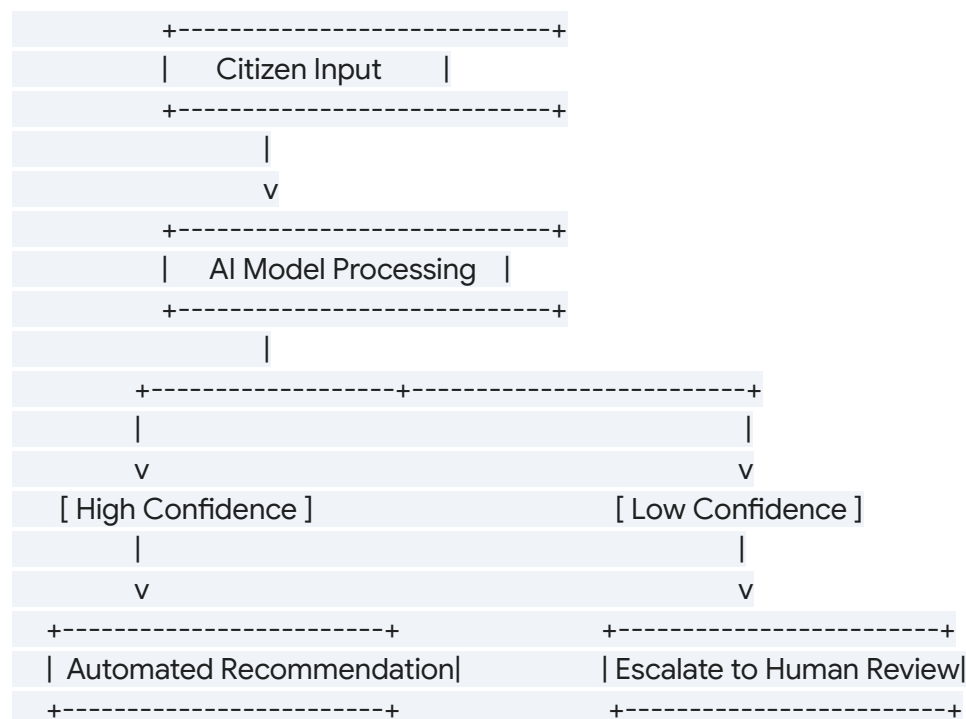
$$\text{\texttt{\$}\text{MVP}} = \text{\texttt{One Golden Path (Not a feature buffet)\text{\texttt{\$}}}}$$

- **Core Sentence Template:** "For [user], our product helps them [achieve outcome] by [core mechanism]."
- **Example:** "For grievance officers, our product reduces triaging time by translating, summarizing, classifying, and routing complaints."

MoSCoW Prioritization Matrix

- **Must Ship (Core Value):** Complaint input, language detection, summary generation, category prediction, urgency score, officer review screen.
- **Should / Could Ship:** Important or nice-to-have features for later iterations.
- **Park / Not Now:** Citizen mobile app, rewards system, advanced analytics, full live government database integration.

AI MVP Guardrails & Confidence Flow

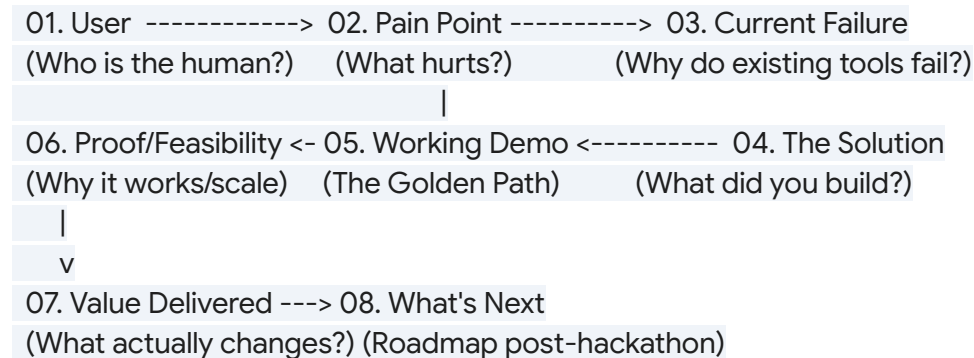


6. Phase 5: The Winning Pitch & Storytelling

What SIH Judges Look For

1. **Problem Understanding & Evidence:** Proving the pain is real.
2. **Technical Feasibility & Scope:** Can it actually work in production?
3. **User Experience & Practicality:** Is the golden path intuitive?
4. **Sustainability & Scale:** Long-term adoption and growth potential.
5. **Pitch Clarity:** Story-driven presentation focused on human impact.

Story Arc Matrix



10 Critical Questions Every Team Must Answer

1. Who exactly is your user?
2. What evidence do you have that this problem exists?
3. What exists today (workarounds/jugaad)?
4. Why is your solution demonstrably better?
5. Why is AI actually necessary here?
6. What is your focused MVP?
7. What data do you need, and how do you handle privacy/edge cases?
8. What is your primary success metric?
9. What can go wrong, and how do you handle failure modes?
10. What happens after SIH (sustainability plan)?

Summary Checklist for Teams

- [] **Decode:** Turned system requirements into a human workflow.
- [] **Validate:** Spoke to users or studied current workarounds.
- [] **Scope:** Built one clear, flawless "Golden Path" MVP.
- [] **Guardrail:** Added human-in-the-loop fallback for low AI confidence.
- [] **Pitch:** Narrated the presentation through the lens of one main-character user.